A GUIDE TO GUT HEALTH

Everything that makes us fully functional human beings is increasingly being linked to the flourishing gut flora in our digestive tract

Graphic by **NILANJAN DAS**

WHAT IS THE GUT?

It is the gastrointestinal system, which is made up of the stomach, small intestine and colon. Its main function is to digest food, absorb nutrients from it and excrete waste matter

IMPORTANCE OF GUT MICROBIOTA

Regulating body functions

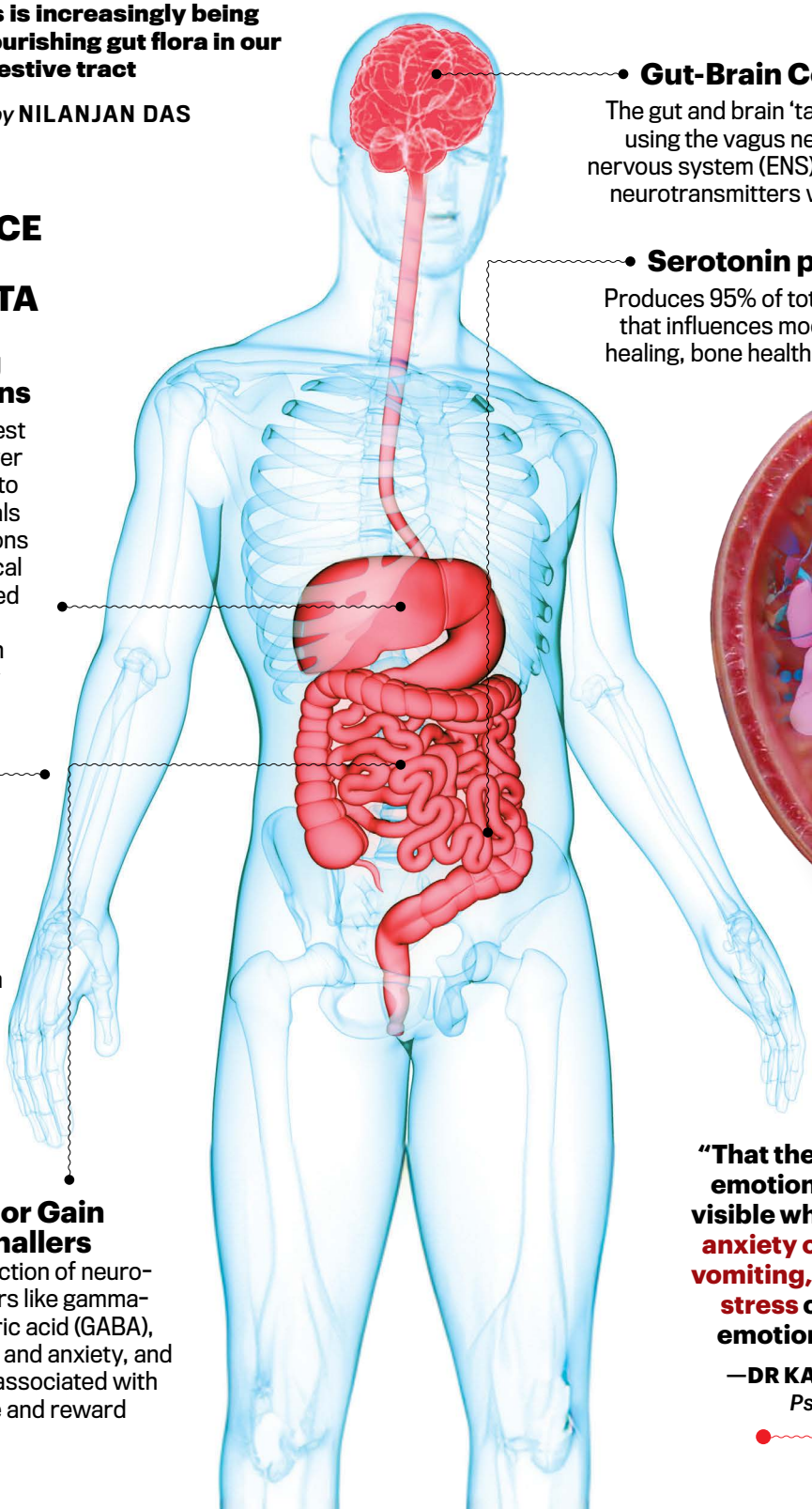
Gut microbes digest bile acids from liver and amino acids to produce chemicals that prompt neurons to release chemical messengers called neuropeptides associated with different bodily functions

Immune system

Plays vital role in regulating immune system

Pain or Gain Signallers

Aids production of neuro-transmitters like gamma-aminobutyric acid (GABA), linked to fear and anxiety, and dopamine, associated with pleasure and reward

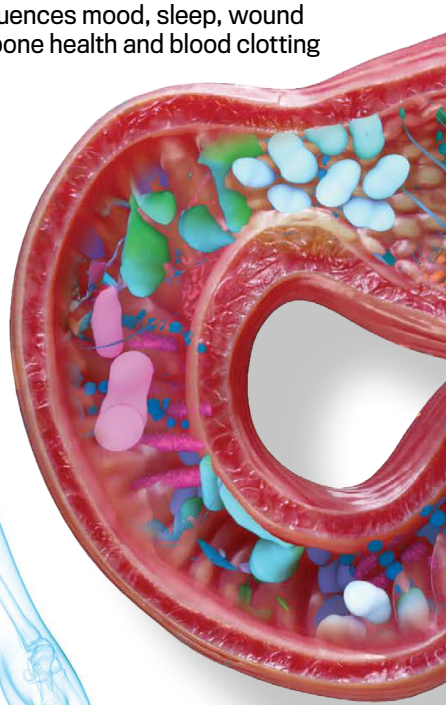


Gut-Brain Connection

The gut and brain 'talk' to one another using the vagus nerve, the enteric nervous system (ENS), and the activity of neurotransmitters within the GI tract

Serotonin production

Produces 95% of total body serotonin, that influences mood, sleep, wound healing, bone health and blood clotting



"That the gut influences emotional response is visible when we consider anxiety or psychogenic vomiting, where physical stress can trigger an emotional response"

—DR KANISHKA MEEL
Psychiatrist